EXPLORATORY FRAMEWORK · FOR DISCUSSION WITH JIM

Sovereign AI × Public Good

Mapping control, influence and opportunity across the AI stack

Where in the AI stack can public-interest organizations exert meaningful influence?

Control is who can change a system directly. **Influence** is who shapes the people who hold control. Sovereignty is not owning every layer. It is meaningful control and freedom from unwanted dependencies. Hypothesis: strengthen the feedback loops that already shape AI, alongside research, policy and philanthropy.

Enables ↑

AI stack	Who controls it?	What can they change?	Who can influence it?	Possible lever (hypothesis)
Applications ●●● Direct	App developers; deployers such as school districts	Prompts, retrieval sources, guardrails, model choice, data retention, pricing	Buyers, procurement committees, users, privacy and legal reviewers	Procurement criteria for outcomes and accessibility
Models ●●○ Mediated	Model developers; open-weight publishers; deployers within license terms	Training data and objectives, weights, fine-tuning, evaluations, hosting. API users: prompts, settings, model choice	API customers, evaluators, red teams, researchers, benchmarks	Domain benchmarks: education-specific evaluations used in model selection
Infrastructure ●●○ Contract terms	Cloud and data center operators; enterprise and national compute	Hosting location, tenancy, security, capacity, pricing, serving stack	Anchor customers, governments, certification bodies	Contract terms: privacy and residency standards in consortium purchasing
Chips ●○○ Indirect	Chip designers, memory and packaging suppliers; governments through export policy	Architecture, memory, software stack, supply allocation, pricing	Largest buyers, governments, benchmark consortia	Aggregated demand: shared cost and efficiency benchmarks (indirect)
Energy ●●○ Civic process	Utilities, grid operators, regulators, data center developers	Generation mix, siting, permitting, cooling and water, power contracts	Regulators, communities, large power buyers	Civic process: community benefit agreements, reporting standards

Demand and feedback ↓

Dots: a working read of how directly customer demand can reach each layer. Not equal across layers. Control and influence are different things.

FIRST PROVING GROUND

EdTech: an AI tutor

1. Students and teachers name the need
2. Researchers and public-interest groups make it measurable
3. Districts add it to purchasing criteria
4. EdTech companies respond to demand
5. Needs reach model, infrastructure and chip choices (the weakest link)
6. Outcomes feed back into evaluations and purchasing

A proposed mechanism to investigate, not an established chain. The signal may weaken at each layer.

WORKING CONCEPT

The New Guard

Leaders already linking technology, adoption and incentives to public-interest outcomes. None named.

STRATEGIC DISCOVERY

1 Who makes consequential decisions?
2 What information shapes them?
3 Which customers pull hardest?
4 Where do developers get feedback?
5 Are public-interest needs represented?
6 What could philanthropy realistically influence?
7 What would create measurable change?
8 Who is already working here?

TO DISCUSS WITH JIM

1 Which layer's decisions could philanthropy realistically influence first?
2 Where do developers get feedback, and whose voice is missing?
3 What intervention could create measurable change in education?

What if we could make the public good an active input into AI innovation, rather than an outcome we attempt to protect after the fact?